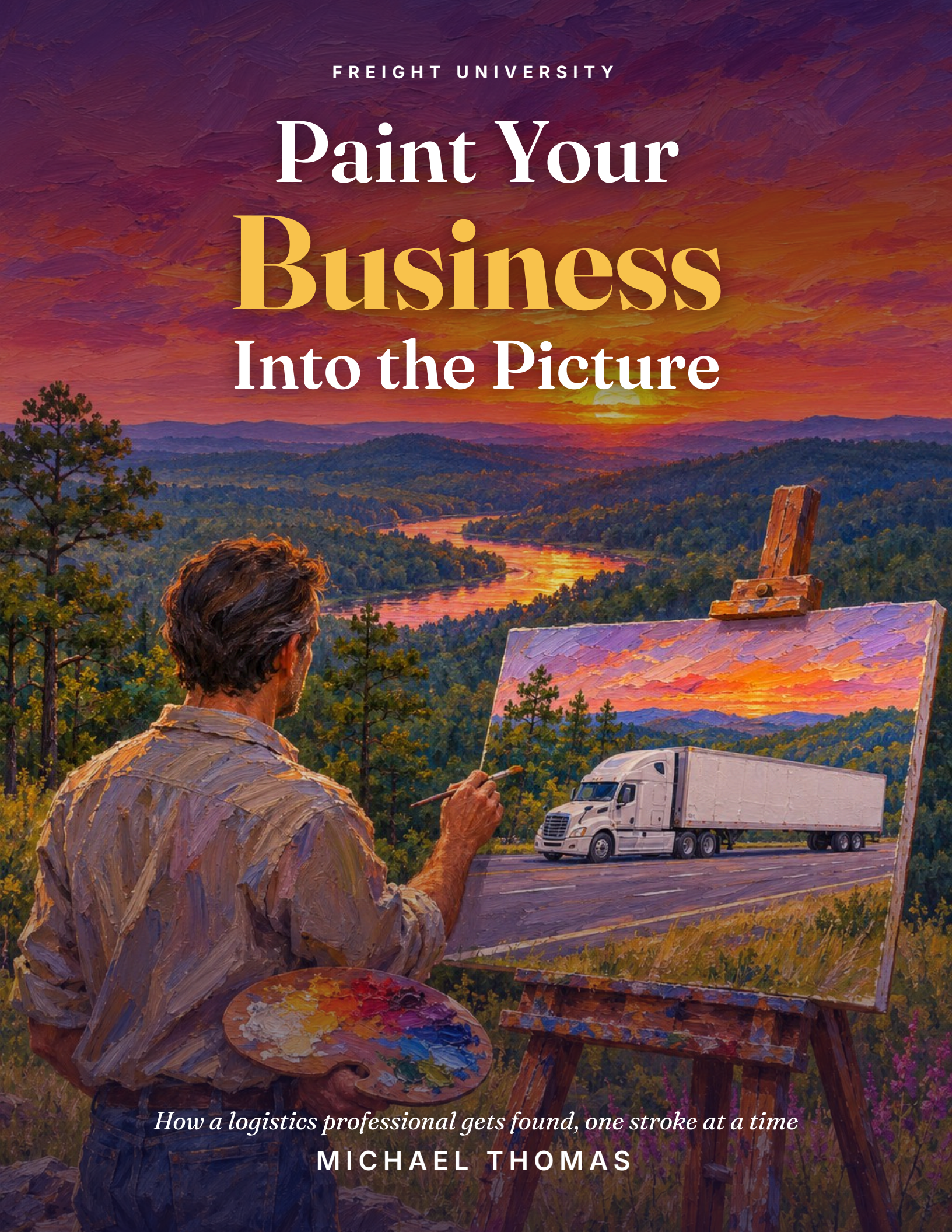
FREIGHT UNIVERSITY

Paint Your Business Into the Picture



How a logistics professional gets found, one stroke at a time

MICHAEL THOMAS

BEFORE YOU PICK UP THE BRUSH

Imagine your phone ringing

Imagine your phone rings one morning, and it's somebody you've never called.

All right. Picture it with me. It's the owner of a small trucking company you've never talked to. They've got two trucks in your state, the paperwork's piling up, and they don't know where their next good load is coming from. So they did what everybody does now. They picked up their phone and searched. And there you popped up. Your name, your face, what you do, how to reach you.

You didn't chase that call. You painted it.

I get excited when I think about this. I've been teaching it for years, and I've got my own name for it. When I hear the word marketing, Bob Ross pops into my head, and I can't separate the two. I'll tell you why in a few pages.

This isn't a book about which button to click. The buttons move. Every few months somebody redesigns something. What I want to give you is how to think about being known, because that doesn't move. It's one of my thinking books. There's no test at the end. It's here to invoke your thinking.

If you've started the course, you already know what a Professional Logistics Service Provider is, and we'll go over it again. This book picks up at the next question. Now that you know what you are, how does anybody find out?

Meet John Smith

You're going to follow one person the whole way through. John Smith is a PLSP in Alabama who helps small trucking companies grow. I'll show you what he did, step by step, and you'll see his actual website, his listing, his posts and his phone.

> **ONE THING TO KNOW**
>
> John is made up. His name, his customers, his reviews, his phone number and every screen in this book are training samples. Copy his thinking. Don't copy his facts. When it's your turn, every word has to be true about you.

The Bob Ross Effect is my teaching comparison. This book isn't connected to or endorsed by Bob Ross Inc. All pictures were made with AI and show nobody real.



STROKE 1 OF 13

The Blank Canvas

Nobody can find you yet, and you may not even know it.

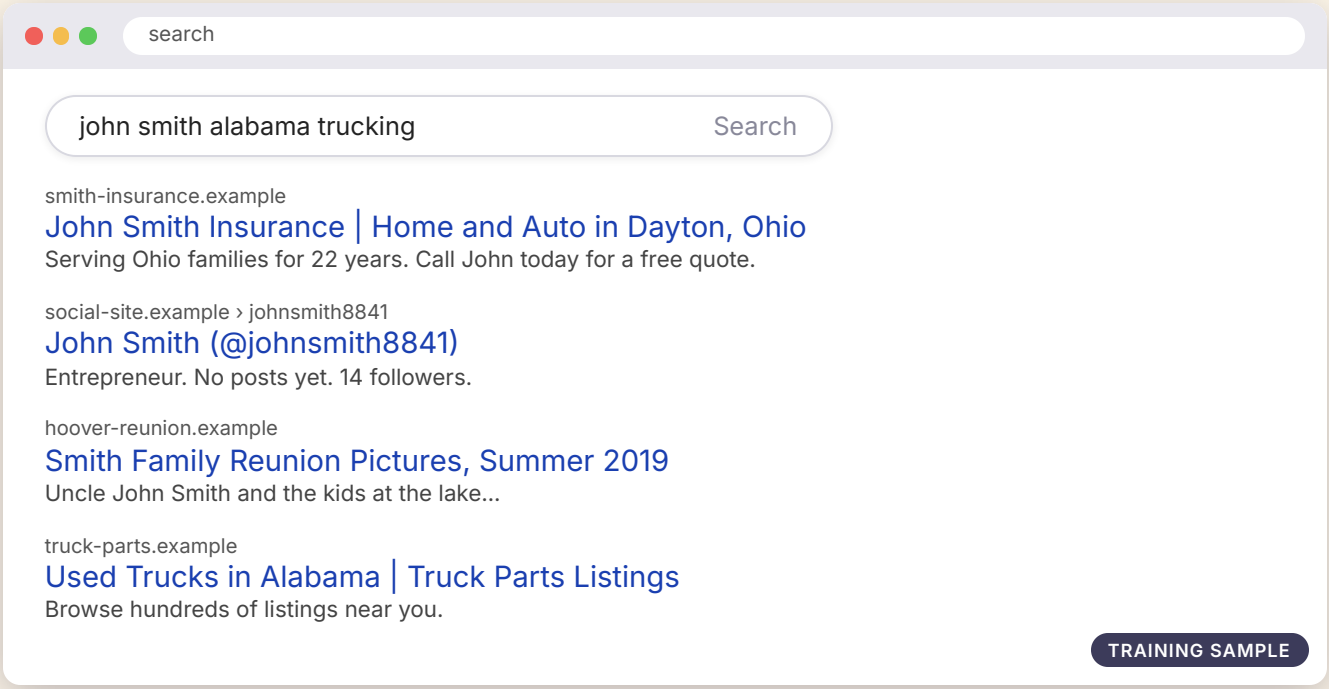
John makes a good call

John Smith just finished his PLSP certification. He lives outside Birmingham, Alabama. He knows how to research freight, he can read a carrier's safety record, and he understands what keeps a small trucking company's cash moving. So he does what you'd do. He picks up the phone.

On Monday he reaches a carrier, which is just a trucking company, in Tuscaloosa with three trucks. It's a good talk. The owner says, "Send me something." John sends a nice email from his free email account, and he feels great about it.

Then nothing. No reply on Tuesday. Nothing on Friday.

Here's what happened on the other end. The owner hung up and did exactly what a careful person does. They typed his name into their phone.



What the Tuscaloosa owner found when they looked John up.

So who's John Smith? A guy in Ohio who sells insurance? Somebody with a laptop looking for a load? That owner has been burned before. There are too many sharks out there. They closed the search and went back to work, and John never knew it happened.

This is a must today

GET THIS

You can make a hundred calls a week and people still won't know who you are. Calling doesn't make you known. Being findable does.

Say it with me: virtual. Everything we do in this business is virtual. People ask me sometimes, is there an office we can come into? We're all virtual. The carriers you'll work with are in other towns. The brokers are in other states. There are docks now where a driver signs in on a screen and never talks to anybody.

A lot of the people you deal with will never meet you. So what they find when they search your name, that's you. That's the whole of it.

Without the internet, without being able to connect in that virtual world, we're dead in the water. The days of phone books and yellow pages are gone, and they're not coming back. A small trucking company owner who needs help today isn't flipping through anything. They're on their phone at a truck stop.

WITHOUT IT

A free email address. No site. No listing. Your name brings up somebody in Ohio.

A person with a phone.

WITH IT

A name, an email at your own web address, and a place where people can see what you do.

A business.

Now, I don't want you to feel bad if your canvas is blank. Every picture I've ever seen started as a blank canvas. It only means you've got something to paint. The problem is when you don't know it's blank.

YOUR TURN

Pull out your phone. Search your own name and your state, the way a stranger would. What comes up? Be honest, and write it down with today's date. You'll want to look back at it.



STROKE 2 OF 13

Know What You're Painting

You can't show people who you are until you can say it in one breath.

What are you?

John's brother-in-law asks him at a cookout what he does now. "Logistics," John says. His brother-in-law nods, and John can see him picturing a warehouse.

That was fine at a cookout. It won't work with a carrier. Every carrier, broker and shipper you talk to is going to ask you some version of the same question: what are you? If you can't answer it clean, they'll answer it for you. They'll decide you're somebody with a laptop looking for a load, and they'll price you that way.

We teach this at the very beginning of the course, because everything else sits on it. A Professional Logistics Service Provider, or PLSP, is the back office for a small trucking company. A big carrier has a whole floor of people handling filings, cash, rates, relationships and records, and four hundred trucks pay for all of it. Somebody with one truck can't hire that department. They never could. That gap is the reason this profession exists.

KNOW THIS FIRST

You find out what you are. You find out what services you offer. Then you make it virtual. That's the order, and your painting is the last step of it.

Your menu

I like to call your services your menu. John sits down and writes his, and he's honest about it. He's strongest at freight research, which means finding where the freight is, what it needs and what a lane really pays. A lane is simply a route trucks run, like Birmingham to Mobile. He can help a new company get built right. He can keep filings and dates organized, and he can help an owner see their cash and keep their records straight.

Hold on to that menu. Your marketing is just your menu, made visible.

Plain words. A **shipper** is the business with freight to move. A **carrier** is the trucking company that hauls it. A **broker** arranges a truck for that freight, for pay. An **owner-operator** owns and drives their own truck.

Don't paint what isn't there

Here's the biggest mistake I see. Somebody sets up a little LLC, Jones Logistics, and builds a website saying, "We work with dry box, intermodal, rail, overseas shipping and flatbed." Oh my goodness. They don't work with any of that. They're lucky to work with one thing and do it well.

John almost did it himself. His first draft said *"John Smith Global Logistics Solutions: serving all your transportation needs nationwide."* He read it out loud to his wife and she asked him, "Who's that?"

Don't try to be anything other than what you are. Most of you aren't building a brand right now. A brand comes ten years down the road. You're a person who's getting started, and that's a good thing, because people trust a person. So John's business is John Smith, PLSP. A trucker can say that name. They can look it up. It's him.

The one-breath sentence

John works on it until he can say it without thinking:

> **"I'm John Smith. I'm a Professional Logistics Service Provider, and I help small trucking companies in Alabama research their freight and grow."**

Who he is. What he is. Who he helps. Where. What for. Every piece of his painting gets built from that sentence.

Where John's menu stops. John isn't brokering. Arranging freight between shippers and carriers for pay takes broker authority from FMCSA, the federal agency over trucking, along with a bond or trust. So John tells the owner where the freight is and what it pays, and the owner books the load. Your menu holds what you're really set up to do today.

YOUR TURN

Say what you are in one sentence, out loud, with no notes. Which of your services could you show somebody today? Which one would you be embarrassed to get asked about?



STROKE 3 OF 13

Why I Call It Bob Ross

People need to see the person before they trust the person.

He painted the whole scene

If you've ever watched Bob Ross on television, you know what I'm talking about. He didn't paint a tree. He painted a whole scene, a little at a time, and the tree landed in it.

And people didn't just watch the painting. They watched him. They saw the man, heard the voice, watched the work happen one stroke at a time, and they trusted him because they could see who he was and what he could do. I've been saying this in class for years.

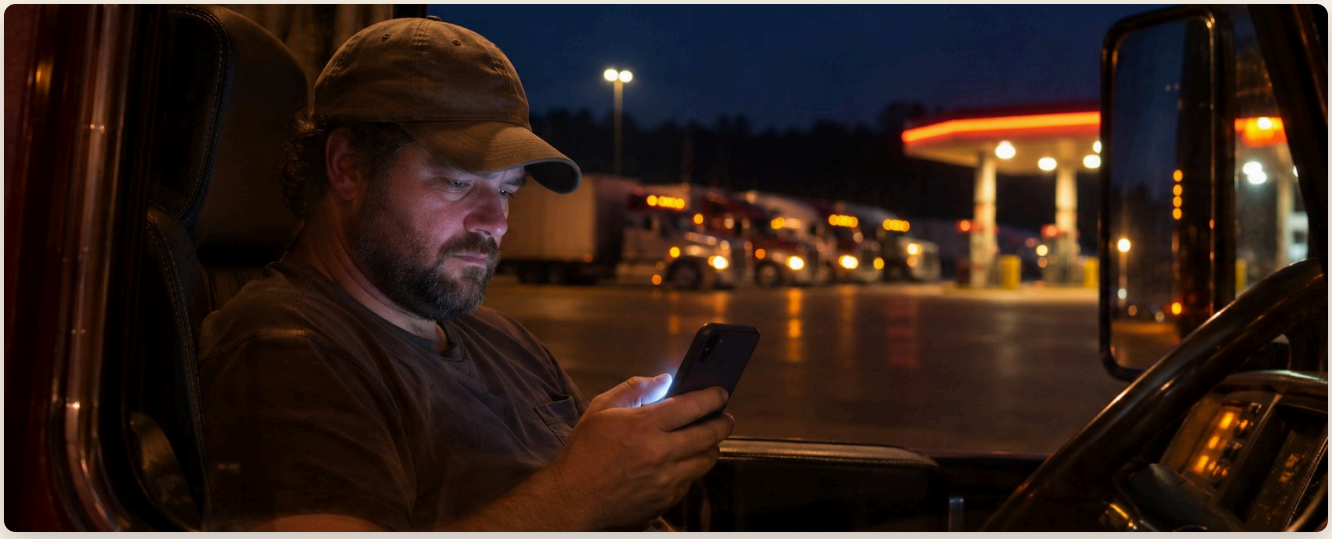
That's your marketing. It isn't a business card or one post. It's a picture of who you are and what you do, painted a little at a time, that people can see from anywhere.

THE BOB ROSS EFFECT

People need to see the person before they trust the person. A picture, a presence, and a place to find you. Painted a little at a time, so that when somebody looks, the whole scene is there.

The picture hangs where you're not

A phone call disappears the moment it's over. An email gets buried. Your picture stays up. It keeps working when you're asleep, when you're on the other line, when you're at your kid's ball game.



2 AM at a truck stop outside Montgomery. An owner-operator is searching for help in Alabama, and John's sound asleep. His picture isn't.

I call it the net

A phone call reaches one person, once. The picture catches people you never knew were looking. I call that the net, and it catches what calls never will.

AT THE TRUCK STOP

A driver in your state is searching for freight at 2 AM. Your name comes up.

A MONTH LATER

A dock manager you talked to once wants to find you again. You're still there.

BEFORE THE CALL

An owner hears your name from another owner and looks you up first. They see a real person doing real work.

It's happened to me more times than I can count. The phone rings out of nowhere and somebody says, "I'm in your area, I saw your page, do you do this?" That's the net.

I get phone calls because I painted my little Bob Ross years ago. I probably hear from a shipper about twice a week who found me on their own. I had a financing company call me up out of the blue wanting to talk about working together. I had a news organization reach out because they saw one of my websites. I never called any of them. I've been at this a long time, so don't expect your phone to do that next month. I'm telling you what a picture does when you keep painting it.

Last time you looked them up

If you've been through the course, you learned how to look a company up before you trust it. How old is the web address? Does the phone match the site? Now turn that around. Somebody just got your email. They're doing exactly what we taught you to do. What do they find?

YOUR TURN

Who's somebody you trusted before you ever met them, just from what you saw of them online? What made you trust them? Write it down. That's what you're about to paint.



STROKE 4 OF 13

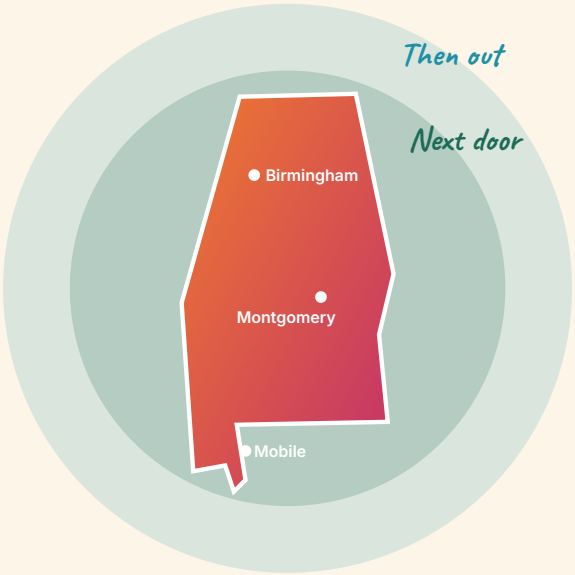
Dominate Your State

The whole country is too big to be known in. One state isn't.

You don't have to be all over the world

Here's where new people go wrong. They say they serve the whole country, because they're afraid of leaving money on the table. And they come up nowhere, because every broker in America is saying the same thing.

Focus on your state first. If you're from Alabama and somebody's searching for freight or trucking services in Alabama, you should pop up. On Google, on the map, and in the AI tools people are starting to ask instead of searching.



One state, then the next

John starts with Alabama and nothing else. Once he's known there, the freight leads him next door. A carrier he works with runs to Georgia. A lane runs through Mississippi or up to Tennessee. His picture grows the same way a painting does, from the part he's already got.

The painting goes where the freight is.

Say your state, plainly and often

Search engines connect you to a place when your page, your listing and your posts all say that place. So John puts Alabama in his page title, in his first sentence, in his service area and in his posts. And he uses the words a real person types, which aren't the words a marketing department would use.

Nobody searches this	People search this
Innovative end-to-end logistics solutions nationwide	**freight out of Alabama**
Your premier transportation partner	**help for small trucking company Alabama**
Comprehensive carrier support services	**trucking compliance services Birmingham**

YOUR TURN

Write down three things somebody in your state would actually type to find what you do.



STROKE 5 OF 13

You Only Need Twenty Trucks

Your state is plenty, because you don't need the whole industry to know you.

Twenty trucks. That's the number.

When people hear "market yourself," they picture billboards. They think they've got to reach everybody, so it feels impossible and they never start. Let me take that off your shoulders.

You only need twenty trucks.

That's what we talk about in the training: building a fleet of twenty. It's not a fleet you own. John doesn't own a single truck. It's twenty trucks you're working with, the companies that lean on you for their freight research and their back office.

And twenty trucks doesn't mean twenty customers. That could be two or three trucking companies. Think about what that means for your marketing. You don't need all of America to know your name. You need a handful of owners in your state to find you, look you over, and pick up the phone.



Three owners. 3 + 5 + 12 = twenty trucks. John's example, made up for this book.

Then it builds on itself. An owner who likes the work tells another owner. A three-truck company grows to five, because you helped it grow, and that's the whole point of what we do. Before you know it you've got twenty trucks or more you're working with.

Now go back and look at that blank canvas. Does painting it still feel too big? Your whole picture only has to catch a few of the right people. Alabama has far more small trucking companies than John will ever need, and your state likely does too.

Twenty is my teaching standard, and no law says twenty. I'm not going to print what twenty trucks pays you, because that depends on your deals. If you go on to be a broker, I'll ask you to spread those trucks across four to six companies, because a broker needs somewhere to put the load when one truck breaks down.



STROKE 6 OF 13

Don't Be Afraid to Invest in Yourself

Education teaches you what to do. Marketing lets you show that you can do it.

It's worth the investment

I've watched people finance a truck without blinking and then tell me a website's too expensive. Invoke your thinking on that one.

WHAT I TELL EVERY CLASS

Investing in yourself is the most important investment you'll make, besides your education.

Your education teaches you how to do it and what to do. Your marketing gives you the ability to show what you can do and what you've learned. One without the other leaves you half built, with all that knowledge and nobody who can see it.

People hear the word marketing and think expense. I want you to think about it the way you think about the education you're getting right now. You put money and time in, and it pays you back for years, because once you're known, you stay known.

A YEAR OF CALLS

Each call reaches one person, once. Nothing stays behind when you hang up.

A YEAR OF PAINTING

Each piece stays up. Every search in your state can find it, for years.

Do both. But only one of them is still working when you stop.

What it really costs

A web address. Mine have cost around $25. A site plan, an email, and whatever you choose to spend on tools or the occasional paid post. For most of you starting out, that's a few hundred dollars a month, and a good part of it is optional. Plus some of your time. Start with what you can carry, and add to it as the work comes in.

I'm not going to tell you what it brings back, because I don't print numbers I can't promise. I'll tell you that in more than twenty years, nothing I've spent on being findable has failed to come back.

John was nervous about it. He'd just paid for his education and money was tight. So he made a short list, bought his web address first, and told himself he'd do the rest one piece at a time. That's how you do it. Don't be afraid to put your money behind yourself.

YOUR PALETTE

Six colors. That's the whole picture.

Here's everything you're going to paint with. I'm telling you what each piece is for, and John's going to show you what it looks like. Same name, same phone, same words on all six.

Name — The first stroke. One name, the same everywhere.

Email — Your name at your own web address. It's the cheapest thing that separates a business from a person.

Page — One page: what you do, who for, what state, how to reach you. Everything points here.

Listing — Your free Google Business Profile, where you show up on the map.

Channel — One social channel, the one you'll actually keep up. Short posts that show the work.

Habit — Twenty minutes a week. One post, one look at the listing, one review asked for, one search of your state.

HOW TO SET THESE UP

This book won't walk you through account screens, and it doesn't need you to learn anything technical. That's my next lesson, **Set Up Your Business**. When you finish this book, go watch it. This book gives you the why. That lesson gives you the how.



STROKE 7 OF 13

Your Name and Your Email

The first two strokes, and the cheapest ones you'll ever make.

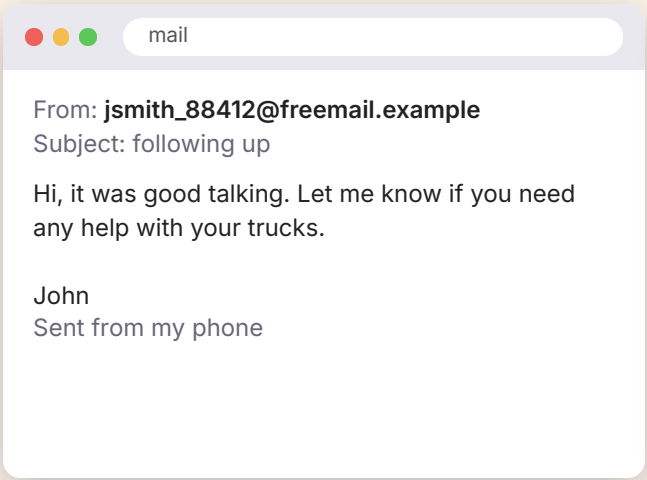
John picks his name

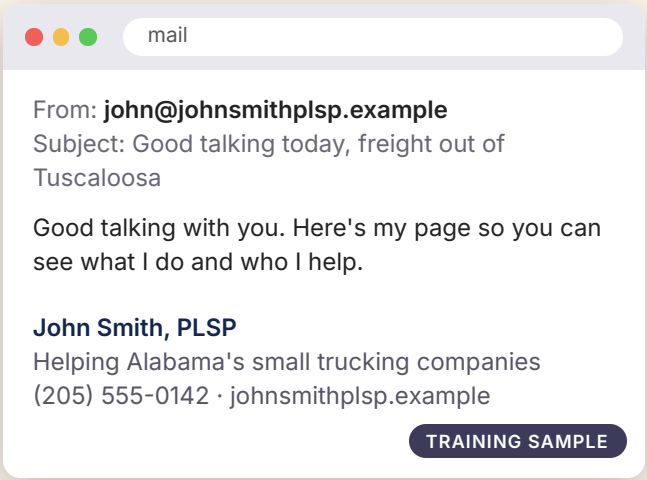
John checks a name three ways before he falls in love with it. Is it free with the state of Alabama, on the Secretary of State's website? Is it free as a web address? Is it free as a name on the social channel he plans to use? Can't get all three? Pick again.

He lands on **John Smith, PLSP**, and the web address **johnsmithplsp**. A plain name people can say, spell and look up. You can always build a company name later.

Then the email

Remember that email that went nowhere? Look at what the Tuscaloosa owner got, and look at what John sends now.





Same man, a few days later, and now there's something to check. A free email tells people you're a person with a phone. Your name at your own web address changes that.

One name. One phone. One email. Everywhere.

John tapes those three things above his desk and copies from them every time, so they never change by accident. That match is how people, search engines and AI tools know it's really you.

YOUR TURN

Pick a name and check it three ways. Then look at what you've already got out there. Does it all use the same name, phone and email? Where doesn't it match?



STROKE 8 OF 13

One Good Page

You don't need a big website. You need one place where you put your menu.

Here's John's page

Do you need a big website with tabs and buttons all over it? No. Everybody needs a landing page, which just means one good page where you put your menu. John built his on Wix, and you don't have to be a programmer to do it. Your own words, a real photo, your state.



1. **His state's in the first line.** People, search engines and AI tools all know where he works at one glance.
2. **Plain words, first person.** He wrote it the way he'd say it to a driver.
3. **A real, friendly photo.** People need to see the person. That's the Bob Ross Effect right there.
4. **One clear next step** and an easy way to reach him, right at the top.
5. **The menu, made visible.** A carrier knows exactly what he does in thirty seconds.

Keep scrolling



Most of the people who find John will find him on a phone, so that's where he checks it. Can you read it without pinching the screen? Can you tap the phone number?

Why he does this

People trust a person with a reason. John says his in a few plain lines, and you need your own true reason here. Don't borrow his. If you didn't grow up around trucks, don't say you did.

Who he helps, and why trust him

He names the owner-operators, the small fleets and the new carriers getting their first loads, in the words they'd use for themselves. Then he shows he's easy to check: his certification, his one name and phone, his real reviews.

Show the work

His latest posts sit right on the page, so the page never looks abandoned.

NOTICE WHAT'S NOT HERE

No "nationwide." No stranger in a headset. No made-up reviews. No promises about money. One real person, one state, a clear menu, and an easy way to reach him.

Everything points here

Now John's got something to send people. When he talks to an owner, he says, "Here's a link to my page. Check it out, you can see what I do and who I help." His email signature, his listing and his posts all point here. It starts small, and it grows.

What people never see on the page

Behind every page there's a title and a short description that search engines and AI tools read. On Wix you fill them in under the page's SEO settings. SEO stands for search engine optimization. I've worked with it for twenty years, and all it means for you is making your page say what you do and where, in the words people search with, so you come up when they look.

Here's John's pattern: what you do, your state, your name.

johnsmithplsp.example

Freight Research & Trucking Help in Alabama | John Smith, PLSP

PLSP certified through Freight University. Freight research, compliance support and company development for small trucking companies across Alabama. Call (205) 555-0142.

That's the only technical thing I'm going to ask of you in this whole book, and if it's more than you want to fool with, an AI assistant will write it from your own sentence. You don't need to set up anything fancy to get started.



John built his page at the kitchen table, in his own words, over a couple of evenings.

YOUR TURN

Write your picture in one paragraph: who you are, what you do, who for, what state, what trailer. Read it on your phone. Could a tired owner at a truck stop understand it in thirty seconds?



STROKE 9 OF 13

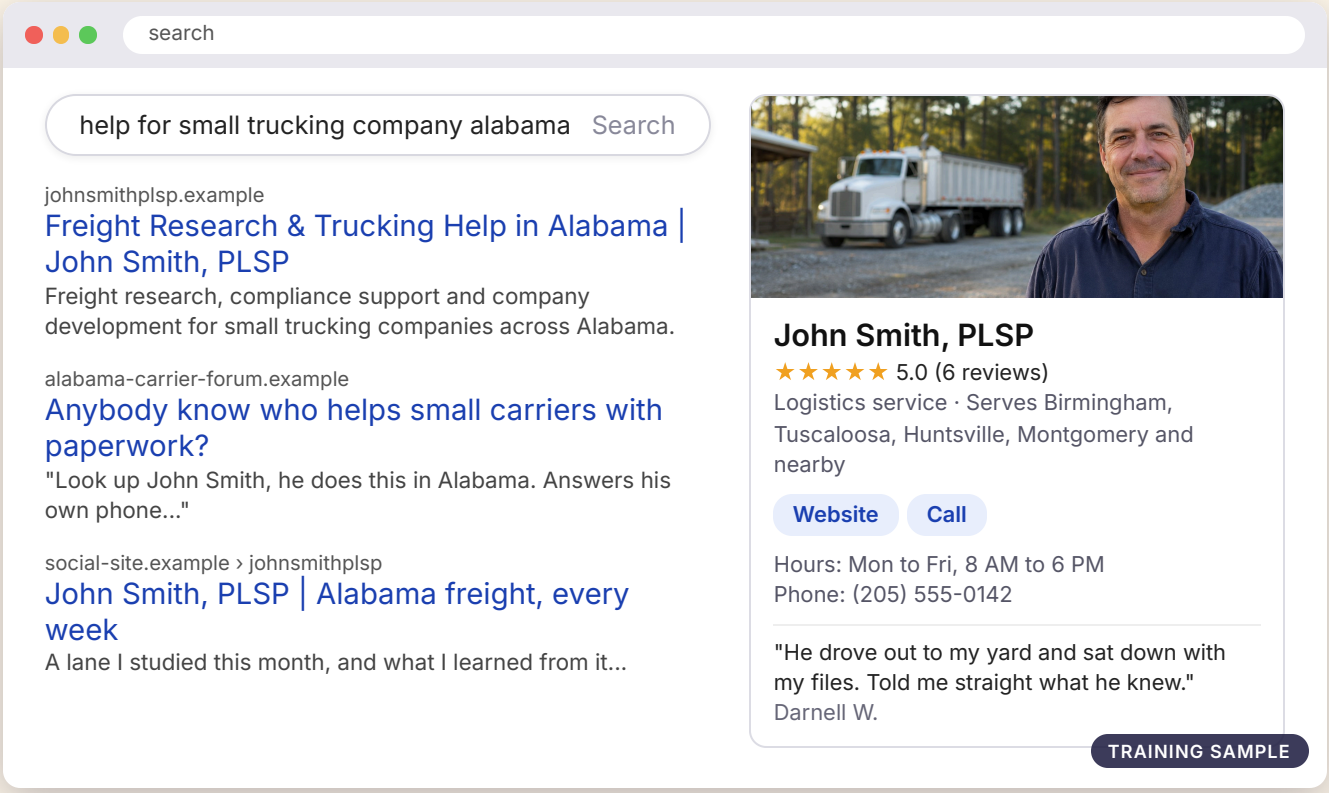
Put Yourself on the Map

When somebody in your state searches for what you do, you want to be on that map.

John gets his Google Business Profile

A Google Business Profile is the free listing that shows up on the map and beside the search results. It's got your name, your phone, your hours, your service area and your reviews.

John fills in every field, with the same name, phone and site as his page. Google asks that a service area stay within about two hours' drive of where you're based, so his listing covers central Alabama. His page and his posts cover the whole state.



Six months in. His page, his post and his listing all come up together, and every one says the same thing. That's one picture.

Here's the rule, and it's a real one

Google says a business has to make in-person contact with customers during its stated hours to qualify, and online-only businesses don't. That's why John's work matters here. He actually goes to see his carriers, at their yards and at their kitchen tables, all over the state. So he sets up as a service-area business, one that goes to its customers, and he leaves his home address off the listing.



John at a carrier's yard. He's in front of real customers, in Alabama, during his stated hours. That's what puts him on the map honestly.

So do what John does. Go see your carriers. It's good for the listing, and it's better for the relationship. And if your business truly is all online, then don't make up an office or a customer visit to get a listing. Google can suspend it. Check the current rule before you apply. You'll still have your page and your channel.

Real reviews only

Reviews are the strokes other people paint for you. After John finishes work for an owner, he asks for one, plainly. "If I helped you, would you put a line on my listing? Say whatever's true." He asks every customer, and he answers every review, good or bad.

> **Never write your own. Never pay for one. You learned what a fake company looks like. Don't let your listing look like one.**

The Federal Trade Commission has a rule against fake reviews, so this is more than good manners. And if nobody's reviewed you yet, that's fine. John had zero for a while. Fill the space with the real thing when it comes.

YOUR TURN

Do you meet your customers in person, in your stated hours? If so, a listing fits you. Which cities within about two hours of you would you list? Who's the first person you'd ask for a real review?



STROKE 10 OF 13

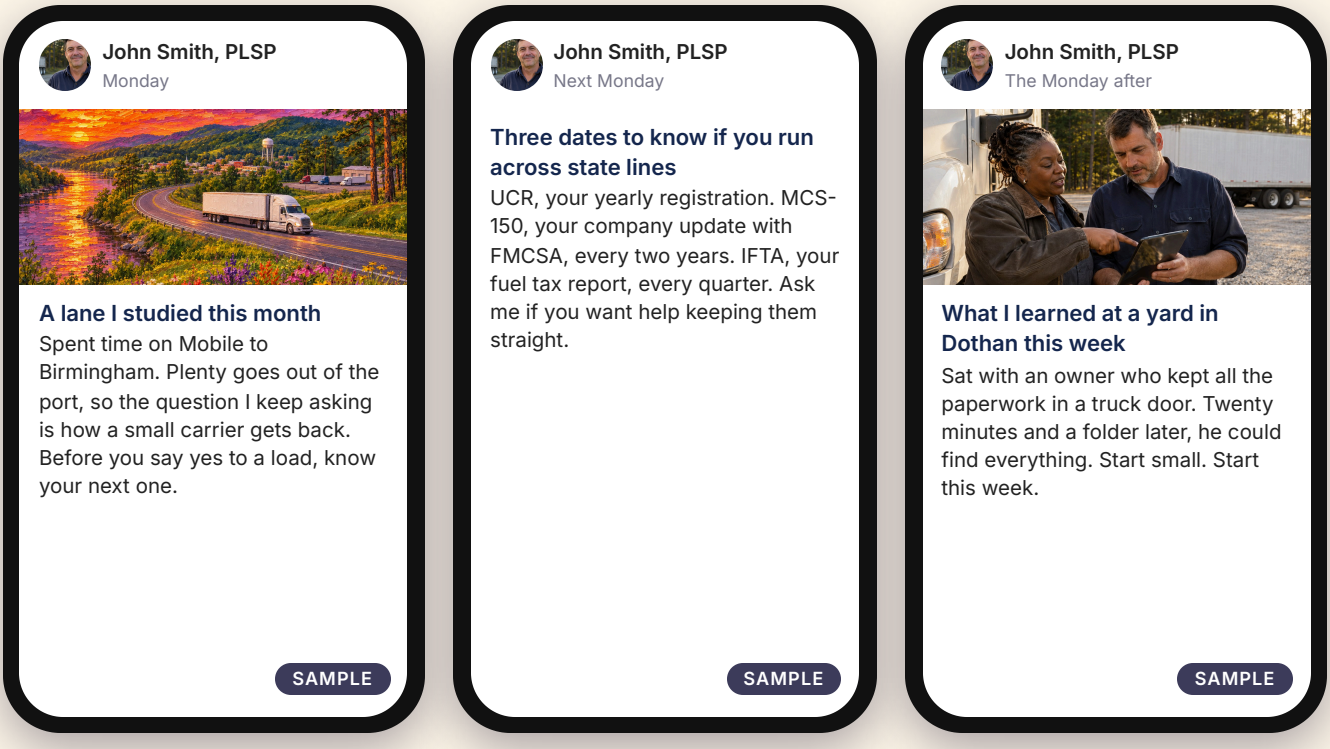
Show the Work

You never have to be on camera. Skills, not face.

One channel, one post a week

Bob Ross showed people he could paint, right there on television. So you show the work too. Pick one social channel: Facebook, Instagram or TikTok. One first. Pick the one you'll actually keep up with. John picks Facebook, because that's where the Alabama trucking groups are.

And you don't have to show your face. A real photo on your page and listing goes a long way. But in your posts, show the lane, the load, the lesson. That's what a carrier wants to see anyway.



Look what John's doing. He's teaching. Every post is one more stroke that shows how he thinks. A channel with two posts looks abandoned. A channel with twenty looks like a business.

He also joins the groups in his industry. If you run dry van, the plain closed trailer a lot of us call dry box, get in those groups. Answer somebody's question when you know the answer. Read each group's rules first, and don't paste the same ad everywhere.

YOUR TURN

Pick your one channel. What's one thing you learned this week that a small carrier could use? That's your first post. Get it up there even if you think it's small.



STROKE 11 OF 13

The Machine Paints With You

AI does the brushwork. You decide what the picture is.

John gets some help

Ten years ago, doing all this alone meant learning to write ads and design, or paying somebody who had. That's over. You don't need to know how the technology works. If you can talk to somebody, you can do this.

John opens an AI assistant and sets up a project for his Bob Ross. He tells it who he is, once, and it remembers. Then every week he tells it what happened.



ONE RULE

The machine writes in your words, or it doesn't write.

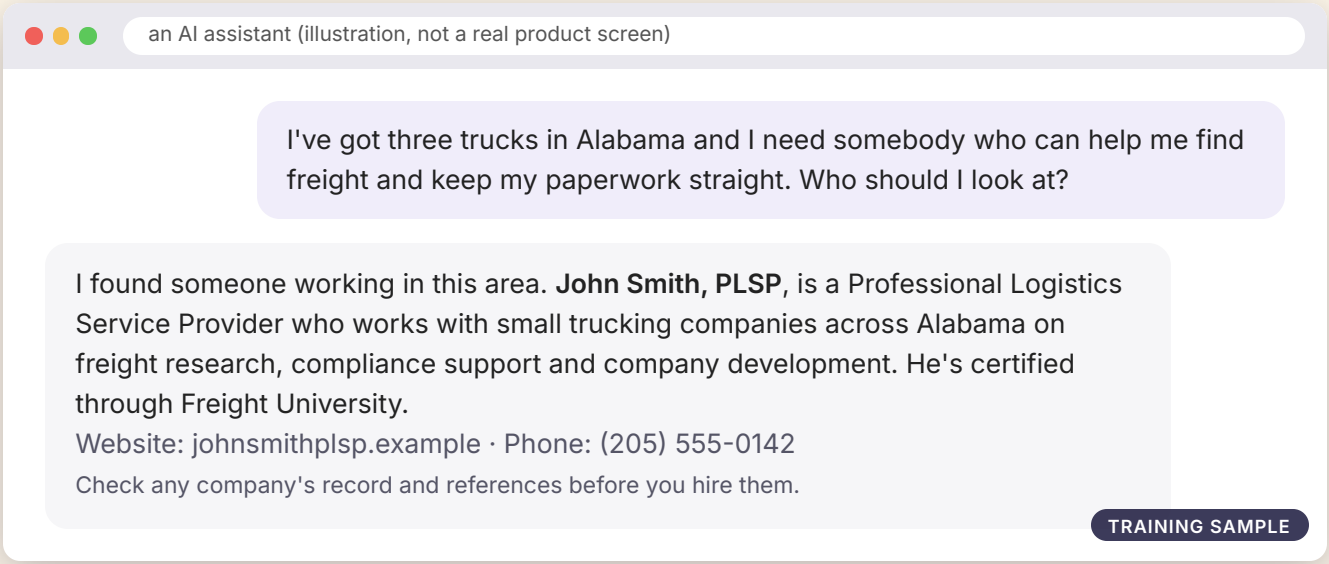
The first draft sounded polished, and it made up a team and a promise John couldn't keep. AI will do that. So you read everything before it goes up, and you fix what isn't you. It's your name on it.

YOUR TURN: SAY THIS TO IT

"I'm [name], a Professional Logistics Service Provider in [state]. I help [who] with [what]. Use only the facts I give you. Don't make up customers, experience, reviews or results. If something's missing, ask me. Write in plain words, the way I'd talk to a driver."

Search is moving to AI

Here's where it's all going. More and more people aren't typing into a search box. They're asking an AI tool a question, the way they'd ask a person. The picture you paint is what those tools read.



That's the answer you'd want somebody to get about you.

Nobody can promise you'll be the one named. Anybody who sells you that promise is selling you something. But these tools draw on the same kinds of things search engines do. Your page, your listing, your reviews, and what's written about you.

So you don't need a separate plan for AI. Paint the picture plainly, in your state, in your words, and you've given them something to find.

A tool can't recommend somebody it can't find.

YOUR TURN

Open an AI tool and ask it the question your customer would ask, with your state in it. Then search the same thing on Google. Write down what comes up, with the date. You'll do it again in three months.



STROKE 12 OF 13

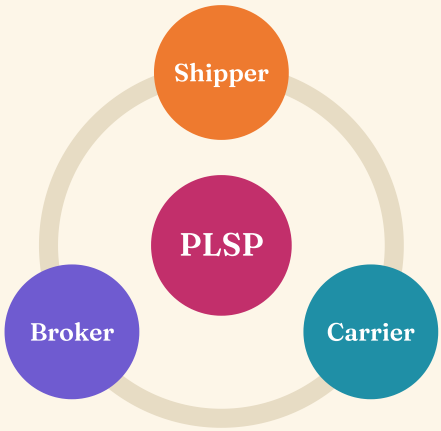
Be Easy to Check

Your picture is how the whole circle finds you, and how they know it's really you.

Being found keeps the circle turning

Being findable isn't vanity. Logistics is a circle. The shipper has freight. The carrier has trucks. The broker has the load. The PLSP works on the business behind the truck, so the small carrier can hold up its end.

When one piece can't find another, the circle breaks, and it's almost always the small carrier who pays for it.



Think about a one-truck owner in your state who can't find anybody to work with, because nobody in the state can be found. They end up alone on a load board, a website where loads get posted, taking what's left. You were twenty miles away the whole time and they never knew. You can't keep a carrier alive if they can't find you.

A name nobody can steal

Here's the other side of it. A scammer can pretend to be a company nobody can find. A crook with a fresh web address and the same name as a real carrier with no page looks just as real. It's a lot harder to pretend to be somebody who's everywhere, with the same name, phone and email going back years.

John makes it easy to check him. Same name everywhere. His certification named correctly. His reviews on Google, written by the people he worked for, where anybody can read them. He never says "our trucks," because he's got none.

THE RULE FOR YOUR WHOLE PICTURE

Every word of it has to be true. A beautiful picture of something that isn't there is exactly what we taught you to run from.

Then paint for your carriers

Once John knows how to do this, he teaches his carriers. Many have no picture at all, and they're missing good drivers and shippers because of it. That's one more reason they can't live without him.



STROKE 13 OF 13

Start Before You're Ready

Search engines are slow. What you put up today shows up months from now.

John didn't wait

You might be thinking, I'll do this after I've got a customer. After I finish the course. After I've got a good logo. Listen to me on this one. That's backward, because search engines are slow. A new site can take weeks to be found at all and months to be trusted. A listing takes time to verify and longer to collect reviews.

So you paint while you learn. By the time you're making real calls, your picture's already been hanging for a while. They look you up, and you're there.

MONTH 1

You exist

Name, email, page and listing are live and they all match. Search yourself and write down what you see.

MONTH 3

You come up

Search like a stranger would and find yourself. A few real reviews, a post a week behind you.

MONTH 6

A stranger calls

Somebody you never contacted finds you. Write down the date. That's the net working.

AFTER THAT

Every call starts from the last one

They looked you up, and you were there.

That's the order things tend to happen. Yours could take longer.

Twenty minutes a week

The painting is never finished, and that's the point. Here's John's whole habit:

One post.
One look at the listing.

One review asked for.
One search of his own state.

MONTH SIX

A Tuesday



John's on his way to Tuscaloosa when his phone rings. He doesn't know the number.

"Is this John Smith? My name's Marcus. I run four trucks out of Dothan, and I'm getting killed on deadhead." That's driving empty, with nothing paying for the miles. "I was looking for somebody in Alabama who does freight research, and your page came up. I read your posts. Do you do this?"

John didn't chase that call. He's never heard of Marcus. He painted it, one stroke at a time, on a lot of Sunday nights when nothing seemed to be happening.

John's made up, and so is his timing. Yours will be your own, and nobody can promise you a stranger's call by a certain date. I'm giving you the order things happen in.



You started with a blank canvas.

A name. An email. One page. A spot on the map. A post a week. Every stroke is still up there working, and now somebody can look you up and see the whole scene.

NOW IT'S YOUR CANVAS

Paint yours

Write this out by hand. Everything you build comes from this page. If you get stuck on a line, that's where your next bit of learning is.

My name, checked three ways

My one-breath sentence: who I am, what I am, who I help, where

My state, and three things people there really type

My menu: what I can really do today

The first real people I'd ask to look at my page

My one channel, and my first post

My twenty minutes: which day, what time

Next: go watch Set Up Your Business. It walks you through setting all of this up. You've got the why. Now go get the how.

ONE MORE THING

Go paint

You're going to make a lot of calls in this business. I want every one of them to start from the last one instead of from zero. That only happens if they can find you.

You've got the education. Somewhere in your state, right now, there's an owner with a truck or two and a stack of paperwork who doesn't know you exist. They're the reason this profession's here. They don't need you to be perfect, and they don't need you to be everywhere. They need to be able to find you, see who you are, and call.

So know what you are. Paint it true. Own your state. Go find your twenty trucks. Don't be afraid to put your money and your time behind yourself. And when your phone rings out of nowhere, pick it up and do what you said you'd do.

That last part matters more than all the rest. The picture gets you the call. Keeping your word keeps the carrier.

Keep your word. Keep your deal. Go paint.

Michael Thomas
Founder — Logistical Forwarding Solutions | Freight University

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Where things come from. Rules and platforms change, so check the current page before you rely on anything here. Reviewed November 2026.
Google Business Profile eligibility and service areas: support.google.com/business/answer/13763036 and /answer/9157481
Google's guide to helpful content: developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/creating-helpful-content
FTC rule on fake reviews, 16 CFR Part 465: ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/consumer-reviews-testimonials-rule-questions-answers
What a broker is, and how a broker shows itself: 49 CFR 371.2 and 371.7, ecfr.gov/current/title-49/part-371
Broker registration: fmcsa.dot.gov/registration/broker-registration
Filing dates in John's sample post: ucr.gov (UCR), 49 CFR 390.19 (MCS-150), iftach.org (IFTA)

The 20-truck standard, the costs and the stories from my own business are my own teaching and experience. They aren't promises of what you'll earn. John Smith, his customers and everything on his screens are made up for training.